UNIT 8

Political Ideologies – Part I



Introduction

Ideology refers to a set of inter-related ideas dealing with politics, society and economy. Political ideologies are very important in Political Science and are considered as heart and soul of Political Science. They deal with the nature and origin of the state, relationship between state and society, forms of government, basis of state authority and sphere of state action. Numerous ideologies operate in our subject.



Learning Objectives

- To understand the meaning and characteristics of Negative Liberalism, Positive Liberalism and Libertarianism.
- To identify the leaders and thinkers who are central to the ideology of Liberalism.
- To know the thinkers, concepts, and ideas of communist stream chronologically in the post Karl Marx period.
- To comprehend the essence of different kinds of Socialisms and to compare and contrast Socialism with Communism.
- To find out the meaning, emergence, theories, intra national and extra national challenges of Nationalism.
- To analyse the causative factors of Indian Nationalism.
- To grasp the etymological origin, core ideological features of Fascism.
- To have knowledge about the emergence, meaning and core characteristics of Nazism.

8.1 Liberalism

Liberalism is the most important ideology of modern political theory. It emerged in the 17th century and continues to be the most widely followed Idealogy in the contemporary world. The etymology of the word liberalism is from 'Liber' that means liberty. The supporters of the Spanish Constitution in the 19th century made the word popular by calling themselves as liberals. Now western countries like United States of America, the United Kingdom, Canada, and Germany adhere to the tenets of liberalism in politics and economy.

Liberalism chronologically had experienced three major phases. In the first phase till 1930 it was called as 'Negative Liberalism'. The second phase termed as 'Positive Liberalism' emerged after the Great Economic Depression and lasted up to the 1970s. The third phase,

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